

Parts of the flag

CANTON: The canton strictly refers to any quarter of the flag, but it commonly means the upper quarter nearest the staff

STAFF: The pole from which the flag is flown

FIELD: The basic area or background color of the flag

FLY: The part of the flag furthest from the staff; the part which flies in the wind

CHARGE: Any emblem placed on the field or added to the basic design of the flag

HOIST: The part of the flag closest to the staff; the part used to hoist or raise the flag

RATIO describes the relative proportions of height against width. For example, ratio: 1:2 represents a flag twice as wide as it is high.

Heraldic terms

CREST: The element which appears at the extreme top of the arms, above the shield

CHIEF: The top third of shield

SUPPORTERS: The figures, human or animal, which hold the shield

SCROLL: The strip—usually below the shield—which contains the motto

WREATH or TORSE: The rope of colors placed above the helmet or shield

MANTLING: The strips of cloth hanging or flying from the wreath

SHIELD: The basic unit on which the coat of arms is portrayed

COMPARTMENT: The base, often a mound, on which the shield stands

